

Section 20

Post-Permanency Risk & Requested Relief

Version 2.0 — Preliminary Draft

Petitioner: Ashley Marie Meredith, MSN | Pro Se

■ PRELIMINARY DRAFT — NOT FOR CITATION OR DISTRIBUTION WITHOUT PERMISSION

PETITION TO AUDIT — IOWA DEPARTMENT OF HEALTH AND HUMAN SERVICES

CHILD WELFARE SYSTEMS — SECTION 20

SECTION 20 — CERTIFICATION OF GOOD FAITH

(Submission Integrity Layer)

Version 1.2 — June 5, 2026

Version 1.0 | June 5, 2026

Audit Petition Packet v2.0 (5/2026)

PURPOSE: This section formally certifies the integrity, intent, and evidentiary good-faith basis of this submission. It constitutes the petitioner's sworn representation to the Iowa Auditor of State regarding the authenticity of sources, the accuracy of analytical characterizations, the lawful basis for inclusion of all records, and the petitioner's non-malicious intent in submitting this petition pursuant to Iowa Code § 11.6(3), Iowa Code § 11.24, and Iowa Rules of Evidence Rule 9.104 (declaration under penalty of perjury, incorporated by reference).

No new analytical content appears in this section. All findings, deficiency characterizations, and audit questions are located in Sections 5 through 19.

20.1 CERTIFICATION STATEMENT

I, Ashley Marie Meredith, MSN, a resident of Benton County, Iowa, submitting this petition pursuant to Iowa Code § 11.6(3), hereby

certify under penalty of perjury that the foregoing petition and all attachments are submitted in good faith and to the best of my knowledge and belief are true, accurate, and not intended to mislead.

I certify that:

(a) All primary source documents included as attachments (A01 through A30 and A33 through A52, including sub-attachments A42A–A42D — 49 primary attachments and 4 sub-attachments) are authentic records obtained from official government agencies, federal oversight bodies, Iowa state agencies, Iowa courts, or third-party organizations through lawful means, including Iowa open records requests, federal FOIA processes, publicly accessible government databases, and court record retrieval.

(b) All analytical content contained in the body of this petition — including but not limited to deficiency characterizations, domain classifications, audit questions, and cross-references — represents my own good-faith analytical interpretation of the primary source record and is clearly distinguishable from the verbatim source materials upon which it is based.

(c) No document has been altered, fabricated, or misrepresented. Where documents have been excerpted, the excerpt is verbatim, the source is fully identified, and the surrounding context does not materially alter the meaning of the excerpt.

(d) Personal case records included in Section 16 are authentic records from my own case file, obtained through lawful means, and submitted solely as contemporaneous documentation of system conditions corroborated by independent federal and state oversight records. They are not submitted as a claim for individual relief.

(e) The open records requests referenced throughout this petition (ORR #26-927 and ORR #26-1536, submitted February 25, 2026 through the Iowa HHS NextRequest portal) are genuine requests and the documents produced in response are authentic agency records.

(f) No material facts known to the petitioner have been omitted

that would alter the determination of audit necessity under Iowa Code § 11.6(3). This petition presents the evidentiary record as assembled; it does not omit evidence that would contradict the central finding of systemic, recurring non-conformity across the 23-year oversight record.

20.2 GOOD FAITH REPRESENTATION

This petition is submitted for the purpose of requesting an independent, external audit of the Iowa Department of Health and Human Services child welfare systems. It is not submitted for the purpose of harassment, intimidation, or interference with any pending administrative or judicial proceeding.

The petitioner has made reasonable efforts to exhaust available non-audit channels prior to submission, including:

- Correspondence with the Iowa HHS Office of the Ombudsman (documented in Section 17 and Attachment A41);
- Correspondence with Iowa legislative offices, including Senator Joni Ernst's office (documented in Section 17 and Attachment A39);
- Open records requests submitted to Iowa HHS through the NextRequest portal (ORR #26-927 and #26-1536, documented in Sections 4 and 18 and Attachments A44–A50);
- Review of publicly available federal oversight materials, including CFSR reports, PIP submissions, APSR filings, and CFSP documents spanning 2003–2026.

The petitioner acknowledges that the Auditor of State retains full discretion under Iowa Code § 11.24 regarding whether, when, and in what form to conduct any examination. This petition does not assert that an audit has been improperly withheld. It requests that the Auditor of State exercise that discretion in light of the 23-year evidentiary record assembled herein.

20.3 VERIFICATION OF SOURCE USAGE

All analytical findings in this petition are traceable to primary

source documents. The following verification principles have been applied throughout:

SOURCE HIERARCHY: Primary government records and federal oversight documents (Sections 6–12) carry the highest evidentiary weight. Independent evaluations and Ombudsman reports (Sections 13–14) carry secondary weight. Media reporting (Sections 15–16) is used as corroboration only, consistent with the evidentiary standards stated in Section 5.6, and is never cited as a substitute for primary documentation.

ATTACHMENT CLASSIFICATION: All documents designated with an A## attachment number are standalone external-source records that have not been altered or editorially supplemented. Petitioner-synthesized analytical products are designated as body content or appendices and are not assigned attachment numbers, consistent with GAGAS evidentiary classification standards and the Excerpted Attachment Rule codified in Section 5.11.

VERBATIM EXCERPTS: All quotations appearing in this petition are verbatim reproductions of the cited source documents. Where ellipses are used, they indicate omitted text that does not materially alter the meaning of the quoted passage. All verbatim excerpts include source identification, document date, and page reference.

AI ASSISTANCE: AI tools were used materially in the preparation of this document. That assistance does not constitute independent verification of any factual claim. All factual characterizations are grounded in primary source documents identified in the evidentiary index (Section 3). See Section 5.8 for the complete AI assistance disclosure.

20.4 NON-MALICIOUS INTENT STATEMENT

The petitioner does not seek by this submission to cause harm to any individual employee of Iowa HHS, to prejudice any pending judicial proceeding, or to interfere with the delivery of child welfare services to Iowa families. Where individual caseworkers, supervisors,

or agency personnel are referenced, they are referenced for the purpose of documenting systemic conditions and institutional patterns, not for the purpose of identifying individuals for public censure.

The petitioner recognizes that many of the deficiencies documented in this petition reflect structural and resource failures that individual workers are not positioned to remedy. The petition's corrective action requests in Section 19 are directed at the institutional level — at policies, procedures, data systems, and oversight mechanisms — not at individual personnel.

The petitioner's interest is in the safety and welfare of Iowa children currently in state care, the integrity of Iowa's child welfare oversight systems, and the accountability of public funds expended in the name of child welfare. These interests are consistent with the purposes of Iowa Code § 11.6 and § 11.24 and with the public accountability mandate of the Iowa Auditor of State.

20.5 SIGNATURE AND SUBMISSION

Submitted this ____ day of _____, 2026.

Ashley Marie Meredith, MSN

Petitioner — Pro Se

1009 A Avenue

Vinton, Iowa 52349

(319) 844-8088

meredithashley.district84@gmail.com

Iowa Code § 11.6(3) Citizen Petition

Iowa Auditor of State — Rob Sand

State Capitol Building, Room 111

Des Moines, Iowa 50319

AI assistance disclosure: See Section 5.8.

End of Section 20 — Version 1.2 — June 5, 2026

Audit Petition Packet v2.0 (5/2026)

AI assistance disclosure: See Section 5.8.

AI assistance was used materially in the preparation of this document. That assistance does not constitute independent verification of any factual claim.